

Hidden computers

Lots of people regularly use computers for work, entertainment, or both. But there are more computers in everyday life than people may be aware of.

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Computers in unexpected places

Nowadays, computers can be found in places you might not expect. It may be in a fork that can tell if a person is eating too fast, a baby-feeding bottle that lets a user know if the baby is swallowing air, and power tools that connect to an app. On a larger scale, traffic lights in many cities can be controlled from a central location. Using data from sensors and video cameras enables controllers to react to heavy traffic or other incidents.

▽ Internet connected

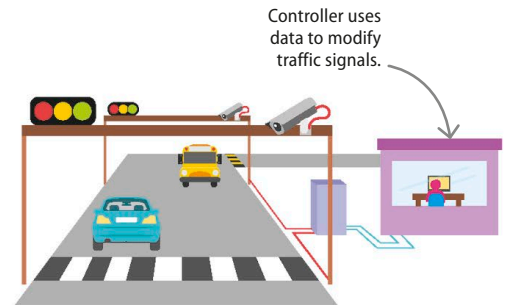
Many smart devices are connected to the internet by cables, Wi-Fi, or Bluetooth. This allows users to control or view data from their devices.



Smart fork



Smart bottle



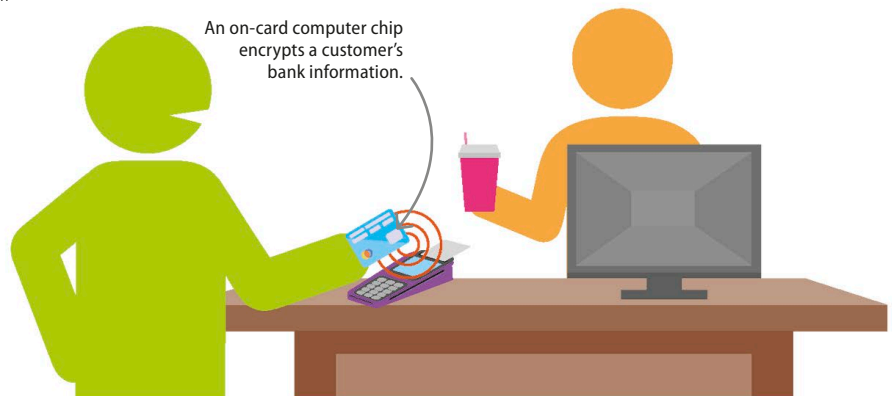
Traffic control

Shopping

Shoppers may find themselves targeted by devices that transmit adverts or special offers to their phones using Bluetooth. If the user has a shop's app installed, the offer will be displayed on their phone. Shops may also use facial analysis software to display adverts tailored to the age or gender of an approaching customer.

▷ Contactless payments

Contactless payment cards send data to a reader device using a tiny transmitter that emits radio waves. The data is encrypted by a specialized computer chip on the card.



An on-card computer chip encrypts a customer's bank information.